Poodle Guide.

The Poodle *grooming* planner

Print it, stick it on the fridge, and keep mats, clips and coat changes on schedule. For Toy, Miniature and Standard Poodles.

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Free to download and print. No email needed. Every figure in this planner comes from a source named on the same page, and the full guides with links are at poodle-care.github.io.

Groomer visits and home sessions

The AKC says many owners take their Poodle to a professional groomer every four to six weeks for a bath, groom and nail trim; VCA puts the usual interval at about six weeks. Write the dates in and tick them off.

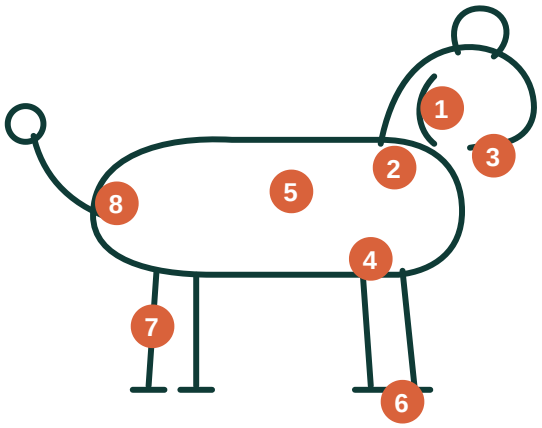
Month	Groomer visit (date, clip)	Home face & feet tidy	Nails done
January			☐
February			☐
March			☐
April			☐
May			☐
June			☐
July			☐
August			☐
September			☐
October			☐
November			☐
December			☐

Before winter, ask your groomer about leg and foot length: snow clumps in long leg hair. See the Poodle snowballs guide on poodle-care.github.io.

Sources: AKC Poodle (Standard) breed profile; VCA Animal Hospitals, Standard Poodle breed guide.

Where mats start, and a weekly check

Preventive Vet explains that mats form most often where there is friction: the collar line, behind the ears, under the chin, the armpits, under the harness, the feet and the back of the rear legs. Comb each spot to the skin with a metal comb.



#	Zone	Mon	Wed	Sat
1	Behind the ears	☐	☐	☐
2	Collar line	☐	☐	☐
3	Under the chin	☐	☐	☐
4	Armpits	☐	☐	☐
5	Under the harness	☐	☐	☐
6	Feet and between toes	☐	☐	☐
7	Back of rear legs	☐	☐	☐
8	Tail base	☐	☐	☐

Preventive Vet notes that Poodle coats mat very quickly, especially after they get wet. After a swim, a bath or a rainy walk, dry the coat fully and do a full brush-out. Brush mats out before a bath, not after.

Source: Preventive Vet, "Why your dog's coat gets matted and what to do about mats". Full interactive map: Poodle Matting Hotspots on poodle-care.github.io.

Track the switch to adult curls

The AKC says puppies in general lose the puppy coat at 4 to 6 months, though it can start at 12 weeks or wait until about a year. Poodles are usually late: OodleLife puts Standards at around 9 to 16 months, and Toys and Minis from around 9 months. Once the change starts, comb to the skin every day.

Age (months)	What I see at the roots	Mats this week?	Groomer / notes
6		☐ none ☐ some	
7		☐ none ☐ some	
8		☐ none ☐ some	
9		☐ none ☐ some	
10		☐ none ☐ some	
11		☐ none ☐ some	
12		☐ none ☐ some	
13		☐ none ☐ some	
14		☐ none ☐ some	
15		☐ none ☐ some	
16		☐ none ☐ some	

Signs the change has started

Tighter curl at the base of the hair while the tips are still soft and fluffy, and mats that come back within days of a brush-out.

OodleLife says most Poodle owners book the first puppy groom between 11 and 16 weeks and recommends one before eight months. If you cannot keep up with daily combing during the change, ask your groomer about a shorter, even clip.

Sources: AKC, "Why does your puppy shed their coat?"; OodleLife, "When do Poodles shed their puppy coat?"

Daily and weekly routine

Short, regular sessions beat one long battle a week. The AKC says that unless your Poodle is kept in a short trim, it needs brushing daily to stop the coat matting near the skin.

When	What	M	T	W	T	F
Every day, about 3 min	Comb behind both ears and through the collar line	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
After walks	Check armpits, legs and feet; remove burrs and wet clumps	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Evening	Line comb one body section in rotation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Weekend	Tail base, feet and the side your Poodle sleeps on	☐ Sat ☐ Sun				
Bath day	Full brush-out first; dry completely, brushing as you dry	Date: _____				

Pair grooming with exercise

A tired dog stands still more easily. The ASPCA suggests at least 30 minutes of aerobic activity a day for active dogs, and the AKC calls swimming great exercise for Poodles. A short brush after the walk fits naturally.

Sources: AKC Poodle (Standard) profile; ASPCA, separation anxiety and enrichment advice. Routine adapted from the Poodle Guide hotspot and coat-change guides.

Home grooming kit checklist

What to have at home between groomer visits. Tick what you already own.

	Item	What it is for
☐	Slicker brush	Removing loose hair and lifting the coat before combing
☐	Metal comb	The real test: if the comb catches at the skin, the knot is still there
☐	Detangling conditioner spray	Preventive Vet suggests a small amount when you work on a mat
☐	Lick mat	Keeps a wiggly dog busy while you comb, also a Preventive Vet tip
☐	Towels and a dryer	A damp coat mats fast, so dry fully after baths and swims
☐	Cordless clipper with an adjustable blade	Face, feet and sanitary tidy between groomer visits
☐	Nail clipper or grinder	The AKC notes all breeds need regular nail trimming
☐	Treats	Short, rewarded sessions, so grooming stays a good thing

Groomer and writer Daryl Conner says most dogs tolerate a #15 blade length on the feet and many do fine with a #30, and that with the right tool four feet take a professional 5 to 8 minutes. Plan for longer the first few times. Our Wahl Bravura2 review compares two cordless clippers for face and feet.

Sources: Preventive Vet; AKC Poodle (Standard) profile; Daryl Conner, "Back to basics: Poodle trims", Groomer to Groomer.

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